

What is a dinosaur?



Giganotosaurus skulls had huge "windows".

Skull holes

Dinosaur skulls had large holes, or "windows". These made them lighter, which was necessary as some of the largest skulls were almost as long as a car.

Meat-eaters had sharp claws.

Plant-eaters had blunt toenails.



Clue in the claws

Meat-eating dinosaurs were known as theropods, which means "beast-footed", because they had sharp, hooked claws on their toes. Plant-eating dinosaurs tended to have blunt hooves or toenails.



Walking tall

Dinosaurs walked on their toes with their legs directly under their bodies.

Dinosaurs walked on upright, pillar-like legs.



Crocodiles stand with their knees and elbows slightly bent.



Lizards sprawl, with their knees and elbows held at right angles to their bodies.



Egg layers

All dinosaurs laid eggs – some in nests, just as birds do today. The baby developed in the egg until it was ready to hatch. About 40 kinds of dinosaur eggs have been discovered.